

The Fourth Way: Sales Playbook

Guidelines, content, and resources to
help you understand and execute a
buyer-focused sales process

The Fourth Way: Sales Playbook

Introduction

This playbook is designed to mimic the steps you take when making a sale. Along each step, you will have a better understanding what your customer is thinking and how you can best prepare for interactions to sell effectively.

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The Buyer's Experience

Sales Process:	Sales Goals:	Buyer's Experience:	Buyer's Actions:
S0: Pre-Qualify	Conduct pre-call research and secure a discovery call.	Recognize they have a need	Buyer becomes aware of their problem.
S1: Qualify	Conduct a discovery conversation to uncover business needs and customer pain points. Determine if the prospect is worth further pursuit.	Identify needs	Buyers examine their needs to determine if a change is warranted.
S2: Pursuit	Engage in deeper discovery with the prospect using implication questions to build need. Handle any objections or roadblocks.	Establish criteria	Buyers develop criteria they will use to evaluate various solutions to meet their needs.
S3: Align & Scope	Engage Solutions Executives and Consultants to gather technical information and provide a demo.	Assess solutions	Buyers assess solutions against their criteria to determine which ones are the best fit.
S4: Negotiate	Negotiate with the client to secure the sale and share a clear path for next steps and timeline.	Mitigate risks	Buyers evaluate their risk in making a change to determine if the reward offsets the risk.
S5: Close, Send Contract	Send the contract and close the deal. Ensure that all are in alignment.	Decide	Buyers select their preferred solution.

Sales Methodologies

A **sales methodology** is a structured approach to selling. It provides a set of guidelines and techniques to help sales teams engage with customers, understand their needs, present solutions, and close deals.

It also helps ensure consistency, improve team performance, and increase sales success.

At Fourth, we focus on three sales methodologies:

- MEDDICC
- SPIN Selling
- BANT

Explore the next few pages of the playbook for specific information related to each methodology.

Sales Methodologies

MEDDICC

MEDDICC is an acronym used to qualify an opportunity.

It prevents salespeople from pursuing opportunities in which:

- The pain and value you are trying to solve for is not strong enough
- The customer is unwilling to run a buying process or doesn't understand their process
- The stakeholders are not strong enough or invested enough to get a deal done

MEDDICC works to:

- Uncover more considerable pain and attach it to metrics, thus driving urgency
- Uncover, influence, and take control of the process and criteria in which the customer will be making their decision
- Build and empower stakeholders to understand the distinct value of your solution

MEDDICC defines:

- **Metrics:** The way you measure the value you provide to your customers
- **Economic Buyer:** Who the overall authority is inside of the customer's organization
- **Decision Criteria:** What criteria is the customer basing their decision upon
- **Decision Process:** What the process is to obtain the decision
- **Paper Process:** What is the process surrounding the paperwork
- **Identified Pain:** What is the pain you are solving, and how serious it is
- **Champion:** Who is the person or persons who are supporting you internally
- **Competition:** What or whom are the other factors competing for the same resources you are



Sales Methodologies

SPIN Selling

SPIN Selling is a methodology that focuses on using **situation, problem, implication**, and **need-payoff** questions to drive sales conversations.

This strategy is focused on actively listening to the customer's needs and tailoring the conversation accordingly.

SPIN Stages:

- **Opening:** the rep focuses on building a sincere relationship with the prospect
- **Investigating:** the rep investigates the prospect's pain points using SPIN questions to uncover opportunities
- **Demonstrating Capability:** the seller demonstrates the value of their solutions by relating it back to the prospect's problems
- **Obtaining Commitment:** the rep determines next steps and closes the deal

SPIN Questions

Below are the four types of questions you should incorporate into your conversations with prospects:

Situation Questions:

- The purpose of Situation Questions is to gather facts and background information about the seller's situation.

Problem Questions:

- Once information about the customer's situation has been gathered, reps can move into the Problem Questions. The purpose of Problem Questions is to uncover the buyer's problems, difficulties, and dissatisfactions.

Implication Questions:

- The main purpose of Implication Questions is to take a problem that the buyer perceives to be small and build it up into a problem large enough to justify action.

Need-Payoff Questions:

- These questions focus the customer's attention on the solution rather than on the problem, which creates a positive problem-solving atmosphere.
- They get the customer telling *you* the benefits, which in turn, reduces objections.



Sales Methodologies

BANT

BANT is a qualification method that helps reps determine whether a prospect is a good fit based on the budget, internal influence, ability to buy, need for the product, and purchase timeline.

It ensures that a lead aligns with our company before continuing to move it through the sales cycle.

Budget: How much is the prospect willing and able to spend on your solution?

Authority: Who is the decision-maker in this sale?

Need: Is there a true need for this solution?

Timeline: How much time will the prospect need to make a purchasing decision?

BANT Questions

Budget Questions:

- What do you currently spend on this problem or need?
- Based on our research, you are currently losing X amount per [timeframe] on this problem. How does that compare to the budget you've set aside?
- How much would it cost you if you haven't fixed this issue in five years?

Authority Questions:

- Who will be using the product?
- When was the last time you bought a similar product?
- How did the decision-making process go?
- Will anyone else be involved in this decision?

Need Questions:

- When did you identify [problem/opportunity]?
- What steps have you already taken to address it?
- How important is addressing this problem to your goals at the company?
- What are your team's goals for the next year? What happens to these goals if you don't address this need?

Timeline Questions:

- Are there any upcoming deadlines for which you'd like to have a solution in place?
- What is your goal for [timeframe]? Will you be able to meet that goal without some sort of change?
- Working backwards from the date you gave me; we'd need to finalize our agreement by [date]. Is that doable?

BANT Page



SMB

Quick Hits

Click on the buttons below to quickly navigate through your team's playbook.



Ideal Customer Profile



Stage 2: Pursuit



Buyer Personas



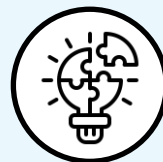
Stage 3: Align & Scope



Stage 0: Pre-Qualify



Stage 4: Negotiate



Core Problems & Framework



Stage 5: Send Contract



Stage 1: Qualify



Stage 6: Post-Close



Ideal Customer Profile



Ideal Customer Profile

When searching for new opportunities, consider how the organization fits with Fourth's capabilities. Ideally, we want to pursue prospects whose characteristics indicate that they would gain value from our solution and in turn, provide value to our company.

Focus your energy on targeting the leads that are most likely to use our system, or our **ideal customer profile**.

An ideal customer profile is a **hypothetical description of the type of company that would gain the most value from Fourth's solutions**. These companies tend to have the quickest, most successful sales cycle and the greatest customer retention rates for Fourth.

SMB

Prioritization A:

- **Location count:** higher end of the range (10-25)
- **Employee count:** 40+ average per location
- Independent or small chain (not part of global concept)
- More corporate owned stores than franchised
- **Type of restaurant:** FSR (HotSchedules)/QSR (PeopleMatter)
- **POS type:** existing integration
- **Location:** states with heavy compliance
- Growing sales and units year over year
- Already a HotSchedules customer

Prioritization B:

- **Location count:** under 10
- **Employee count:** 40+ average per location
- Growing sales and units year over year
- Total net new deal
- Existing customers

Prioritization C:

- Closed lost deals
- Restaurants that are looking to grow
- Businesses that are "not ready yet"

If a prospect does not meet these requirements, or only meets some of these requirements, they should be put into a drip campaign.

The sales rep can then check if they fit our requirements again in six months.



Ideal Customer Profile

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PEO

Prioritization A:

- **Location count:** higher end of the range (10-35)
- **Employee count:** not relevant
- Independent or small chain (not part of global concept)
- More corporate owned stores than franchised
- **Type of restaurant:** FSR (HotSchedules)/QSR (PeopleMatter)
- **POS type:** existing integration
- **Location:** states with heavy compliance
- Growing sales and units year over year
- Currently in the Install base or have a PEO

Prioritization B:

- Growing year over year
- Recently experienced a cost increase
- Want to plug profit leak
- Does not have an HR person in-house

Prioritization C:

- Closed lost deals
- Looking to grow in the next year
- Staff is overwhelmed by HR duties and compliance
- Not ready now but maybe later

If a prospect does not meet these requirements, or only meets some of these requirements, they should be put into a drip campaign.

The sales rep can then check if they fit our requirements again in six months.



Buyer Personas

Buyer personas are **fictional representations of your ideal customer** based on market research and client/prospect feedback.

They help sellers identify how your buyers buy and how you can better sell to their needs.

Explore the next few pages of the playbook to learn more about the buyer personas that your team commonly interacts with.



Buyer Persona:

Owner/Operator (SMB)



These buyers are focused on maintaining consistency across multiple locations, optimizing operations, and controlling costs. When issues arise, such as staffing shortages or supply chain disruptions, they must ensure quick and effective resolution to minimize impact. They seek software solutions that provide centralized control, streamline multi-location management, enhance operational efficiency, and offer clear ROI to support strategic growth and smooth daily operations.

Responsibilities generally include:

- Managing daily operations
- Hiring, training, and scheduling staff
- Ensuring profitability and cost control
- Compliance with labor regulations
- Quickly addressing staffing shortages and supply chain issues
- Supporting strategic growth and expansion initiatives

Implications for sellers:

- Without growth, their restaurant chain will stagnate
- Might not have the right data insights to maintain standards across locations
- They don't have enough hours in the day
- Fear of non-compliance
- Hiring and retaining staff is a challenge

What they are measured on:

- Revenue and profit margins
- Customer satisfaction
- Operational efficiency
- Customer satisfaction/repeat business

Common objections:

- Cost and ROI
- Complexity of rollout
- Integration timeline
- Time to train and employee buy-in
- Change management

Stats that will worry them:

According to restaurant owners, labor management tasks like **payroll** (44%), **labor compliance** (38%), managing **overtime** (20%), employee **scheduling** (18%), and computing **tips and compensation** (18%) are becoming more challenging.



Buyer Persona: **HR, Benefits, Talent Administration (SMB)**



These buyers are focused on recruiting, retaining, and managing a diverse workforce while ensuring compliance with labor laws. When issues like high turnover or benefits questions arise, they must address them promptly to maintain staff satisfaction and operational continuity. They seek software solutions that streamline recruitment, onboarding, benefits management, and compliance tracking, offering clear insights and efficiency to manage HR functions effectively across multiple locations.

Responsibilities generally include:

- Recruiting and onboarding staff
- Managing employee benefits enrollment
- Ensuring compliance with labor laws
- Handling employee relations
- Implementing HR software solutions

What they are measured on:

- Employee performance and retention
- Time-to-fill for open positions
- Benefits enrollment
- Compliance with labor laws and regulations

Implications for sellers:

- Hiring and retaining staff is a challenge
- Administering benefits programs is time-consuming
- Compliance with labor laws is a constant worry
- Training and development are critical

Common objections:

- Impact on employee experience
- Regulatory compliance
- Impact to current processes
- Time to train and employee adoption

Stats that will worry them:

78% restaurant operators **do not have enough employees** to support customer demand

18% is average **loss gross revenue** per store from improper staffing versus demand

69% of hourly employees admit to living **paycheck to paycheck**

45% of operators **need more employees** to meet customer demand



Buyer Persona:

Operations (SMB)



These buyers are focused on ensuring operational consistency, efficiency, and quality service. When issues such as equipment failures or supply shortages occur, they must quickly coordinate resolutions to avoid service disruptions. They seek software solutions that enhance inventory management, streamline maintenance scheduling, provide real-time operational insights, and improve overall efficiency, helping them maintain high standards and operational control across all locations.

Responsibilities generally include:

- Overseeing daily operations and managing issues across locations
- Managing supply chain and inventory
- Streamlining workflows
- Implementing technology solutions

Implications for sellers:

- Operational inefficiencies are a major concern
- Maintaining consistent customer experiences is challenging
- Managing logistics and supply chain complexity is tough
- Ensuring compliance with safety standards is essential

What they are measured on:

- Operational efficiency and consistency
- Customer satisfaction and experience
- Cost control and inventory management
- Compliance with health and safety regulations
- Location performance and profitability

Common objections:

- Operational downtime
- System alignment with other tech
- Performance and speed
- Support for multi-location management/oversight

Stats that will worry them:

98% of operators say higher labor costs are an issue for their restaurant. **97%** cite higher food costs.

73% of diners agree that restaurant technology **improves their guest experience.**



Buyer Persona:

Payroll (SMB)



These buyers are focused on ensuring accurate and timely payroll processing, managing complex wage calculations, and maintaining compliance with payroll regulations. When issues like payroll errors or compliance questions arise, they need to resolve them swiftly to ensure employee satisfaction and regulatory adherence. They seek solutions that automate payroll processing, integrate time tracking, handle multi-location payroll complexities, and provide robust compliance tools, ensuring accuracy in payroll management across all locations.

Responsibilities generally include:

- Processing payroll accurately
- Ensuring compliance with payroll laws
- Managing timekeeping systems
- Handling payroll inquiries
- Implementing payroll software

What they are measured on:

- Accuracy of payroll processing
- Compliance with tax laws and regulations
- Cost control and labor management

Implications for sellers:

- Payroll errors and delays cause major headaches
- They don't have enough hours in the day to manage payroll complexities
- Fear of non-compliance with payroll regulations is keeping them up at night
- Managing payroll for a growing workforce is challenging

Common objections:

- Accuracy and reliability
- Ease of use and impact to current process
- Handling of payroll compliance
- Integration with existing systems
- Support when needed

Stats that will worry them:

33% employers who make **regular errors when processing payroll** according to the IRS



Influencer: IT (SMB)



These IT influencers face challenges such as ensuring cybersecurity, integrating new technologies with existing systems, and providing consistent IT support across all locations. They influence technology decisions by advocating for cost-effective software solutions that offer robust security features, ease of integration, and user-friendly interfaces. They seek platforms that enhance operational efficiency, protect sensitive data, and can be easily managed within a smaller network.

Responsibilities generally include:

- Managing technology infrastructure
- Implementing software solutions
- Troubleshooting technical issues
- Ensuring data security and compliance
- Supporting innovation and digital initiatives

Implications for sellers:

- System reliability and uptime are critical to avoid disruptions
- They don't have enough hours in the day to manage IT issues
- Fear of security breaches and data loss is keeping them up at night
- Integrating new technologies with existing systems is a constant challenge

What they are measured on:

- System uptime and reliability across all locations
- Network security and data protection measures
- Implementation and integration of technology solutions
- Technology-driven operational efficiencies and cost savings

Common objections:

- Integration complexity
- Implementation timeline
- Security vulnerabilities
- Technical support
- Impact on IT workload

Stats that will worry them:

54% of restaurants plan to spend more on technology in 2024.



Influencer:

Finance (SMB)



These finance influencers influence financial software choices by emphasizing the need for automation in accounting processes, real-time financial insights, and straightforward compliance tools. They advocate for solutions that simplify financial operations, offer clear and comprehensive reporting, and support efficient financial management within a limited budget.

Responsibilities generally include:

- Financial reporting and analysis
- Budgeting and cost management
- Cash flow management
- Compliance and risk management
- Financial planning and forecasting

Implications for sellers:

- Accurate and timely financial reporting is essential for decision-making
- They don't have enough hours in the day to manage financial complexities
- Fear of non-compliance with financial regulations is keeping them up at night
- Controlling costs and managing budgets are ongoing challenges

What they are measured on:

- Accuracy of financial reporting
- Budget adherence
- Accounts receivable and payable management
- Cash flow forecasting and optimization
- Financial analysis and decision support

Common objections:

- Cost and ROI
- Financial data security
- Complexity of reporting
- Impact on existing processes

Stats that will worry them:

38% say their restaurants were not profitable last year.



Influencer:

Franchisees (SMB)



These franchisee influencers influence purchasing decisions by highlighting the need for practical and scalable solutions that address operational inefficiencies and compliance requirements. They advocate for software platforms that provide centralized management, real-time analytics, and easy integration with franchisor systems, ensuring smooth operations and high standards across all locations.

Responsibilities generally include:

- Managing daily operations
- Hiring, training, and scheduling staff
- Ensuring profitability and cost control
- Ensuring compliance with brand standards
- Supporting strategic growth initiatives

What they are measured on:

- Revenue growth and profitability
- Brand consistency and compliance with franchise standards
- Customer satisfaction
- Operational efficiency and cost control

Implications for sellers:

- Without growth, their franchises will fail
- They don't have enough hours in the day to manage multiple locations
- Fear of non-compliance with brand and regulatory standards is keeping them up at night
- Hiring and retaining quality staff across locations is a constant challenge

Common objections:

- Consistency across locations
- Support for franchise operations
- Impact to franchise autonomy

Stats that will worry them:

According to restaurant owners, labor management tasks like **payroll (44%)**, **labor compliance (38%)**, managing **overtime (20%)**, employee **scheduling (18%)**, and computing **tips and compensation (18%)** are becoming more challenging.



The Fourth Way

Sales Process



What is a Sales Process?

A **sales process** is a set of steps that sales teams use to turn potential customers into buyers. These steps include finding leads, making contact, assessing needs, presenting solutions, addressing concerns, closing the sale, and following up.

Having a sales process helps sales teams work more efficiently, stay organized, and improve their chances of making sales. It also ensures that everyone follows the same method, which makes it easier to track progress and make improvements.

The Fourth Sales Process consists of five stages:

- **S0 – Pre-Qualify:** The rep conducts pre-call research and secures a discovery call.
- **S1 – Qualify:** The rep conducts a discovery conversation to uncover business needs/pain points and determine if the prospect is worth further pursuit.
- **S2 – Pursuit:** The rep engages in deeper discovery with the prospect using implication questions to build need and handles any objections/roadblocks.
- **S3 – Align & Scope:** The rep engages Solutions Executives to gather technical information and provide a personalized demo based on the prospect's needs.
- **S4 – Negotiate:** The rep negotiates with the client to secure a sale and shares a clear path for next steps and timeline.
- **S5 – Send Contract:** The rep ensures that all are in alignment, sends a contract, and closes the deal.

What is Entry and Exit Criteria?

- **Entry Criteria:** The specific requirements that must be met before a prospect can enter the next stage of the sales pipeline
- **Exit Criteria:** The specific requirements that must be met before a prospect can be moved to the next stage of the sales pipeline or moved out of the sales pipeline



Stage 0: Pre-Qualify

Pre-Call Research & Prospecting



Stage 0: Pre-Qualify

Goal: Conduct pre-call research and secure a discovery call.

How do I enter this stage?

Entry to Stage 0:

- SDR/AE/CSM is prepared to have a strategic discussion
- Identifies upsell opportunity
- SDR creates SO opportunity and passes it to the AE

What happens at this stage?

Activities:

- Prioritize territory
- Conduct pre-call research and prepare for discovery call
- SDR schedules discovery call with Account Executive

Exit to Stage 1:

- SDR schedules discovery call with Account Executive
- Discovery call occurs with AE/CSM, and SI Opportunity is created in SFDC
- Next steps on the calendar are scheduled
- Build/customize slide deck (if using)
- Create need hypothesis

Exit to No Opportunity:

- Discovery call needs to have occurred
- If not qualified, opportunity is disqualified and moved into nurture track





Stage 0: Pre-Qualify

Prospecting

Prospecting is about finding and connecting with potential customers who might be interested in our solutions. During this step, salespeople research and reach out to new leads by networking, engaging on social media, emailing, and calling.

The goal is to build a list of prospects that reps can then convert into customers.

Fourth Expectations

When it comes to prospecting, your goal should be to leave the day with **one meeting no matter what**. To accomplish this, follow the steps below:

1. Pick a target to focus on.

- Use the information in the Ideal Customer Profile section of the playbook to help determine how to best prioritize your accounts.

2. Build your weekly list (2 hours per week).

- Prioritize the Install base in Salesforce.
 - Find out what solutions your prospects already have, if they were “closed lost” at some point, their general history, and where there might be an opportunity for conversation.
- For outside targets, look for compelling events.

3. Research your list (5 minutes per contact).

- Use the Pre-Call Research Checklist to research your prospects.
- Utilize Google, LinkedIn Sales Navigator, ZoomInfo, and Technomic to conduct your research. For PEO, also use Affinity.
- Record any contact information you can find on your [weekly call sheet template](#).

4. Make your calls (2 hours a day).

- Your goal should be to make at least 50 calls a day to get one meeting.
- Secure the meeting with a goal to conduct a 15-minute discovery call within the next two weeks.

5. Refine your list for the next day (1 hour a day).

- If you call 50 contacts and three people answer, move the 47 contacts to the next day's list and add three more to hit 50.
- Refresh your list every Friday. For instance, if you hit a contact 14 times with no response, remove them from the list and replace with a new contact.



Pipeline Management

Leveraging the buyer process and sales process will improve your pipeline management.

Follow the best practices below to ensure that the deals that are included in your pipeline have a higher probability of closing.

Pipeline Management Best Practices

- **Make sure deals are qualified prior to entering the pipeline.**
 - Leverage BANT to win (and lose) deals fast. Don't waste time on a deal that isn't going anywhere.
- **Make sure deals are accurately staged.**
 - Be aware of where you and the prospect are in the sales process. The sales process section of this playbook will help you identify the appropriate stage.
- **Update data on some interval and when it changes.**
 - When a deal is moving through the sales process, make note of important interactions or changes in stage on a regular basis. Set time aside daily to update data when it changes. This will help you see which deals are progressing, and which are stagnating.
- **Update probability in each of the stages.**
 - Take time to update the probability of each deal closing as they move through each stage. If you feel the probability is increasing as the deal progresses, keep going. If the probability of close stagnates, then you might be better off to cut that deal loose and focus on more promising opportunities.
- **Ensure that the size of the pipeline is sufficient to close your quota.**
 - Knowing how much pipeline you need to meet your number helps with time allocation, deal selection, and outreach efforts. A good rule of thumb is to maintain a pipeline that is always 4x annual quota. You can't hit a target if you don't know where it is.



Pipeline Management

- **Ensure the contents of the pipeline are in line with the GTM strategy.**
 - Make sure to look at your pipeline and ensure that the deals we are pursuing are in line with Fourth's GTM strategy. This way your goals and the goals of the company are in sync, and you will be compensated appropriately for your efforts.
- **Review with your manager frequently for a reality check and coaching.**
 - Your manager and peers should be leveraged as a tool when building out your pipeline. They can help you see gaps or opportunities that you may have overlooked. Seek coaching when a deal is stuck.
- **Find deals that haven't been touched for a while.**
 - If a deal has sat in your pipeline for an extended period without moving, then reassess where they are in the sales process and if they deserve more of your time. Try to keep deals from stagnating by emphasizing the urgency that brought them to you in the first place. And if that isn't possible, move them to a nurturing motion while you spend your time and energy on deals that will close sooner rather than later.
- **Remove deals that disqualify themselves.**
 - The faster we disqualify the bad deals, the sooner we can spend our time and energy on the good deals. Always be looking for disqualification criteria with your deals. If you lose sight of the budget, authority, need, or timing, it's better to cut the deal loose and spend your time on prospects that want to buy your products.
- **Maintain a constant, consistent prospecting motion.**
 - To support your efforts, leverage tools like Groove or resources like SDRs to help you identify new opportunities.

Better pipeline management leads to better outcomes. The more efficient you become at helping prospects enter the pipeline, advance in the pipeline, and exit the pipeline, the more successful you will be as a salesperson.



Stage 0: Pre-Qualify

Pre-Call Research Checklist

When speaking with a prospect, don't waste their time by asking questions that are easily researchable. Instead, dig into their specific needs and pain points.

Use the checklist below to ensure that you have adequately researched your prospect before getting on the phone:

- ✓ **Did you use Salesforce to review the prospect's recent activity and account history?**
 - What is their experience with Fourth?
 - Have they used our solutions before?
- ✓ **Did you use tools like LinkedIn, ZoomInfo, Zywave (PEO), or Technomic (LMM) to research?**
 - What is the prospect's position within the company?
 - Who is their boss?
 - Can you make any personal connections to help build rapport? (Mutual interests, organizations, locations, etc.)
- ✓ **Did you look at the prospect's website to learn about their situation?**
 - Where is the business located?
 - How many locations do they have?
 - What type of concept is it?
 - How long have they been in business?
 - Who are some of their main competitors?
 - Do we have any current customers that share similar processes, pain points, etc.?
 - Where have they worked previously? Did they work somewhere that should have been a customer?
- ✓ **Do you understand the buyer persona?**
 - Do I really understand what motivates this persona?
 - Do I understand what a day in the life of this person looks like?
- ✓ **Did you look for compelling events?**
 - Leadership changes
 - Compliance changes in their state
 - Expansion/Mergers
 - Layoffs

Pre-Call Research Checklist





Stage 0: Pre-Qualify

Getting Past the Gatekeeper

A **“gatekeeper”** is a person who controls access to a decision-maker within an organization.

Think: receptionist, office manager, assistant, etc.

Sales reps need to build rapport and navigate conversations with the gatekeeper to get to share their pitch with the true decision-makers.

When you get a gatekeeper on the phone, there are two approaches you can take: **friendly** or **direct**. Explore best practices and strategies for each approach below.

Friendly:

Best Practices:

- Show respect
- Make it clear that you *want* to be on the phone with them, but that you also need access to the decision-maker.

Strategies:

Asking for help:

- “Can you help me...?”
- “I’m sure you will know the answer...”
- “I was told that you’re the person that can help me out...”

Polite frustration:

- “I’ve been trying to reach this person for days and am at a loss – when you need to reach them, how do you do it?”
- “I’ve hit a wall and don’t know what to do. Can you keep me from running into this again?”

Direct:

Best Practices:

- Be firm, but not arrogant.
- Ask for exactly what you want.
- Remove pleasantries.
- Answer questions truthfully with as few words as possible.

Strategies:

“Just”:

- “Just tell her my name is Richard.”
- “Just tell him I sent an email over.”

Conversation Enders:

- “Please tell him Richard called. Thank you.”
- “Just tell him I’m following up on my email, thanks.”



Stage 0: Pre-Qualify

Call Scripts to Hook the Customer



Stage 0: Pre-Qualify

Call Script #1: “Yes, yes, yes”

Is this Richard?

...Yes

And you are still at ____?

...Yes?

And you're still the **[insert title]**?

...Yes?

Thank you. This is Richard, and we are speaking with other _____ to understand how you're approaching... **[Core Fourth Problem]**

I was wondering who I should speak with about this at your organization?

Who is this?

Oh, sorry about that, this is _____ from Fourth and I was wondering who I should speak with about _____?

Call Script #2: “Oh wow!”

Oh wow, someone actually picked up the phone. You may have just made my day!

I know you are busy so I will be brief, and I promise if you don't like what I have to say, you're welcome to just hang up. Is that fair?

Who is this?

Oh, sorry about that. This is _____ from Fourth and we are speaking with other _____ to understand how you're approaching... **[Core Fourth Problem]**

Who should I speak with about this at your organization?



Stage 0: Pre-Qualify

Call Script #3: "27 Seconds"

Hi, I'm _____ from Fourth.

I know I am an interruption; can I have 27 seconds to tell you why I called?

I believe we have discovered a breakthrough in **AWARENESS STATEMENT**.

The reason I reached out to you today is to get 15 minutes on your calendar to share that breakthrough with you.

Do you happen to have your calendar available?

How about later today at 2:00? I think you might want to hear how **[story]**:



Stage 0: Pre-Qualify

Core Customer Problems



Stage 0: Pre-Qualify

Core Customer Problems

At Fourth, we believe there are **four core customer problems**.

While the customer won't always mention these problems specifically, they will give you clues in the form of symptoms. Your job is to uncover these problems and tie it back to where we helped our customers solve their problem with our solutions.

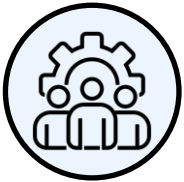
Core Customer Problem Symptom Words:

Below are the four core customer problems and their symptom words.



Not Making Enough Money

"Rising labor costs, food cost is high compounded by inventory waste, inflation, sales decline, economies slow, unforeseen expenses"



Overwhelmed Staff: Especially Managers

"Key members living paycheck to paycheck causing high stress levels, staff burnout due to labor shortage, long hours causing overtime problems cutting into margins which leads to low morale and customer complaints, declining service quality, inadequate breaks causes frequent mistakes"



Complicated & Messy IT Systems

"Too many logins, tech is siloed and doesn't communicate with each other, inconsistent data, slow reporting, unsophisticated tech leads to poor decision-making for operators, customer dissatisfaction with inconsistent experiences, employee performance issues due to inappropriate staffing levels, inventory management problems, sales tracking week over week/year over year, lack of real-time data"



Compliance: Am I in trouble?

"Compliance problems & regulatory confusion due to state & federal regulations, frequent violations, documentation challenges, training gaps, high fines, audit stress, health and safety concerns, operational disruptions, record-keeping inefficiencies, supply chain issues"



Stage 0: Pre-Qualify

Once you successfully get a prospect on the phone, make sure that you are fully present and embrace their feelings through **active listening**.

Why Does Active Listening Matter?

- It helps your prospects to “fall in trust” with you.
- It allows the prospect to explore their own emotions and commit to them.
- Once the prospect hears their own words, they will be ready to listen to yours.

What Does Active Listening Look Like?

- **Focus:** No social media, cell phones, etc.
- **Physical:** Eye contact, smiling, good posture, note-taking
- **Verbal:** Summarizing, non-judgmental, asking questions, psychological mirroring
- **Emotional:** Patience

Use the **Prospecting and Discovery Framework** below to incorporate active listening and empathy into your conversations with prospects. Once the prospect shares a problem statement, respond in the following way:

Prospecting/Discovery Framework Script

Identify Customer Problem

Part 1: Sentence to show empathy and understanding.

Part 2: Here are a couple of examples I’ve seen before of someone struggling with the same thing as you and how we helped them solve their problem.

Part 3: We did that by deploying **[product]**, which did **[XYZ]** for them and created **[ROI]**.

Part 4: If we could do that for you, would that make a dent in the problem that is causing you pain?

Closing: If so, can I schedule 30 minutes to talk about this when you have more time?

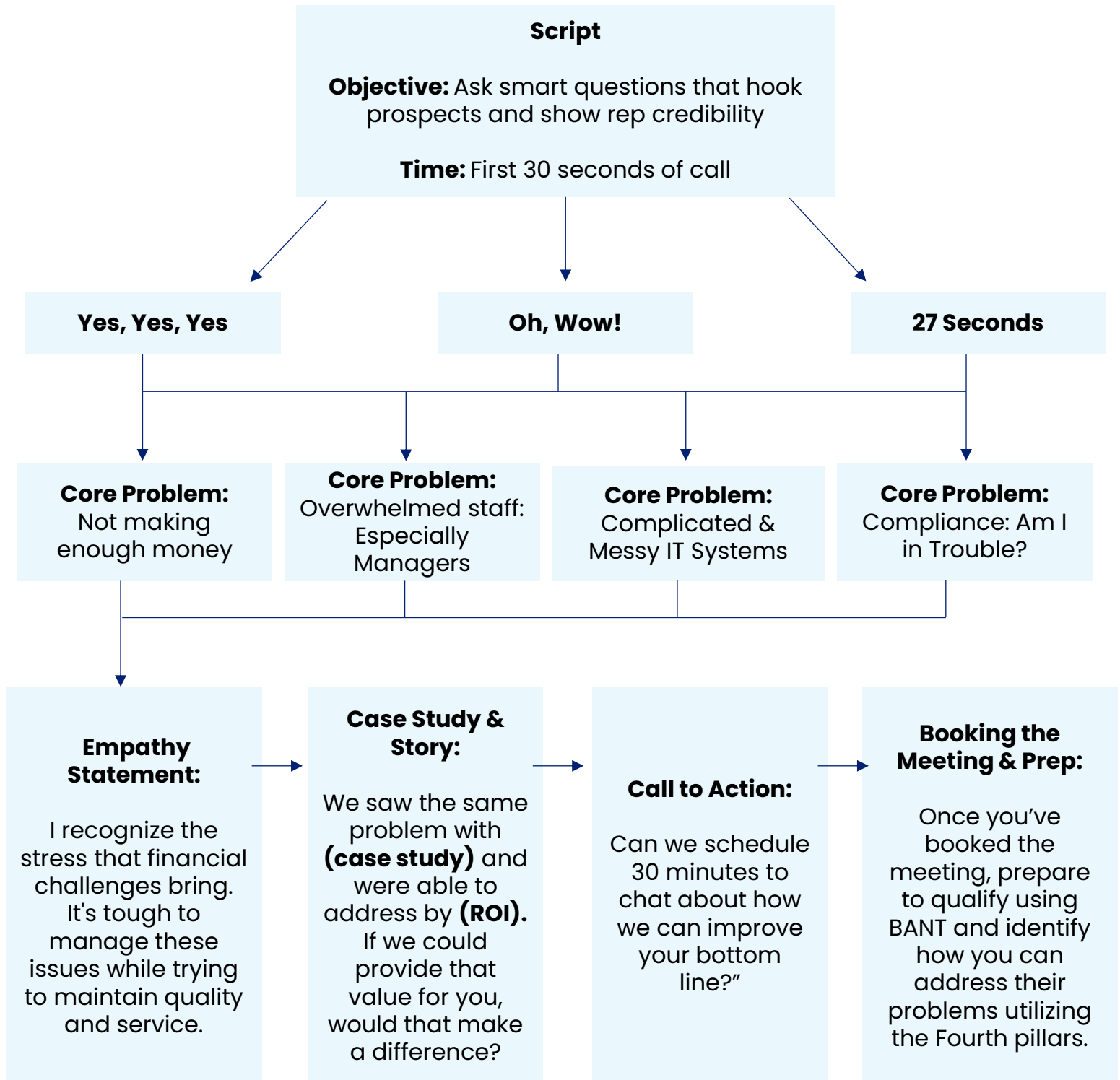
Prospect: “I have too much administrative headache that I’m dealing with, and I can’t focus on what matters most.”

Rep: “It sounds like you’re carrying a heavy load of administrative tasks that are keeping you from focusing on your priorities. That can be challenging. I saw the same issue at **[customer]**, and we fixed it by doing **[XYZ]**. We did that by deploying **[product]**. I can see that helping you by delivering **[XYZ, ROI]**. If we could deliver the same value to you, would that help you focus on more important matters? If so, can we set up a meeting to talk about it?”



Stage 0: Pre-Qualify

The Fourth Way Matrix





Stage 0: Pre-Qualify

Prospecting Scripts with Case Studies (SMB)

Not Making Enough Money:

I hear you, it's tough managing these issues while trying to maintain quality and service. Would you be open to hearing what our most successful clients say about how we've helped them?

We saw the same problem with FreeRange Concepts and were able to address it by increasing labor forecasting accuracy to 95%, so they could maximize sales and profitability at every location. We also reduced labor costs across 12 concepts. What would it mean for your business if we could do the same for you?

Can we schedule 30 minutes to chat about how we can improve your bottom line? How does your calendar look tomorrow at 2pm for a deeper conversation?

Overwhelmed Staff, Especially Managers:

Well, for what it's worth, you're not the only one who's frustrated by the time-suck of administrative demands. It's taking a toll on everyone.

We saw the same problem with Bombshell Restaurants and were able to contribute to a 20% drop in manual scheduling, which gave managers more time to focus on the team and guest experience. If we can do the same for you, how much easier would your day to day be? What could you then spend more time on?

Can we schedule 30 minutes to chat about how we can help reduce your stress? How does your calendar look tomorrow at 2pm for a deeper conversation?



Stage 0: Pre-Qualify

Prospecting Scripts with Case Studies (SMB)

Complicated and Messy IT Systems

Well, for what it's worth, you're not the only one who tells us they cannot get the simple things done because of cloudy and fuzzy data.

We saw the same problem with FreeRange Concepts and were able to address by enhancing in-store and above-store visibility with better data accuracy and reporting for all 12 locations. What would you be able to do better if you had clear and accurate data at your fingertips?

Can we schedule 30 minutes to chat about how we can improve transparency and efficiencies into your operations? How does your calendar look tomorrow at 2pm for a deeper conversation?

Compliance: Am I in Trouble?

Yeah, we hear it's already hard enough running a restaurant and then to navigate all of the compliance issues just makes it even harder. I'm curious, how much time each week are you spending on compliance-related issues?

We saw the same problem with Ford's Garage and were able to address it by offloading payroll processing, human resources, and compliance administration. How much easier would life be if we could help reduce this compliance burden?

Can we schedule 30 minutes to dive into how we can help you manage compliance?



Stage 0: Pre-Qualify

Emails/LinkedIn Messages That Work



Stage 0: Pre-Qualify

Email Templates That Work

Commonalities:

Subject: Your ...

Nick,

I was researching your company and **(Personal Touch)**. This prompted me to reach out to you because **(we share the same Personal Touch)**.

Quick "Awareness Statement." Some of our notable clients include ... **(Include 3)**.

Who is the best person to speak with at your organization about our solutions?

Sincerely,

Your Name
Your Phone
Company Link

Your Competitor:

Subject: Your competitor is _____

Nick,

I recently saw your competitor, _____, is growing (using/trying) _____ with great success.

Quick "Awareness Statement." Some of our notable clients include ... **(Include 3)**.

If you're interested in learning more, please let me know.

Sincerely,

Your Name
Your Phone
Company Link

Are you really #1?

Subject: Your desire to be #1 in your industry

Nick,

I saw you are in great company with _____ and _____. Would you say you are #1 in your space or are you trying to reach #1 in your space?

Quick "Awareness Statement." Some of our notable clients include ... **(Include 3)**.

Would you be open to learning more about this?

Sincerely,

Your Name
Your Phone
Company Link



Stage 0: Pre-Qualify

LinkedIn Connection Messages That Work

Hi _____,

Flattery

I am new to the industry and would love someone to ask the occasional question that's outside my own company. Could we connect? Don't worry, the question is not about setting a meeting.

Richard

Hi _____,

Rapport

Thanks for liking, commenting, sharing on my post. Would love to connect. Don't worry, not about to turn around and pitch or ask for a meeting.

Richard

Hi _____,

3rd Party Rapport

I saw you liked/commented on _____'s post about _____. I'd love to connect, as I have similar interests.

Don't worry, not about to turn around and ask for a meeting or pitch you anything.

Richard

Hi _____,

Direct

Yup, I am asking for a meeting because we solve these pains.

If you're interested, I am happy to set up some time; if not, that's ok, I'd still like to connect since we share

_____.

Richard

Hi _____,

Adding Value

We just wrote about _____ and it made me think it would be good to connect.

Don't worry, not about to ask for a meeting, just spreading good karma.

Richard

Hi _____,

Hope

It seems like we have _____ in common - would love to connect.

Don't worry, not asking for a meeting. Just a connection to share and learn from each other.

Richard



Stage 1: Qualify

Discovery



Stage 1: Qualify

Goal: Conduct a discovery conversation to uncover business needs and customer pain points. Determine if a prospect is worth further pursuit.

How do I enter this stage?

Entry to Stage 1:

- Discovery call with SDR is completed and account meets Sales Accepted Opportunity (prospect admitted to pain and committed to next steps)
- Opportunity is converted to qualification
- If not qualified, opportunity is closed lost.

What happens at this stage?

Activities:

- Account Executive runs a quick introductory call (light level discovery and pitch for ~15 minutes) and confirms there is no disqualifying criteria
- AE uncovers business needs, pain points, budget, authority, decision-making process, and timeline (BANT)

Exit to Stage 2:

- You know: POS, payroll system, pay period, tip management, pay card present, tip card present
- Demo scheduled with HR, Payroll, Finance, IT
- Potential champion and metrics identified
- Reviewed business need discovery questions and identified how to position
- Completed Discovery Checklist/Qualification rubric





Stage 1: Qualify

Initial Discovery Call

Once you've conducted outreach, researched your prospect, and prepared for the call, it's time to get on the phone. Your first interaction with a prospect should be focused on making efficient use of their time and asking strong questions around pain points. The prospect should talk 70% of the time, while you should only talk for 30%. Use the [short pitch deck here](#) if necessary.

Your main goals for the call should be to:

- Identify the business's top three priorities
- Clarify the decision-maker's responsibility
- Discuss the champion's priorities
- Understand their challenges and the impact they have on the business and the person
- Determine budget and timeline – how does prospect make funding decisions?
- Learn the prospect's vision for a solution
- Share quick value prop to keep prospect excited
- Summarize next steps

Structuring the Call:

Use the **"ACE Strategy"** to open your call.

- **"A**ppreciate you taking time for today's call."
- **C**heck End Time:
 - **Seller:** "We have 30 minutes scheduled for today – does that still work for you?"
 - Determine if the buyer has less time than the invite is scheduled for, so you can shorten the agenda if necessary.
- **E**nd Goal –
 - **Buyer:** "What do you want to get out of today's meeting?"
 - **Seller:** "The goal of this meeting is to understand your pain points and requirements to see how we can potentially help. If you think it's a good fit, then we'll discuss possible next steps."

After opening the call, you should move into the **Business Needs Discovery Questions** on the next page.



Stage 1: Qualify

Move through the questions below to uncover your prospect's priorities, business needs, and pain points. You will likely only have 15–30 minutes for this conversation.

Business Needs Discovery Questions:

Answers:

Can you explain what piqued your interest to take the call today?	
We've been hearing that [current customers in industry] are struggling with not enough money, administrative headache, insight into their data, and compliance this year. Which one of these problems resonates with you? What would you add?	
How would you rank these priorities in order of importance? Why are they important to you?	
Is executing on [#1 priority] a challenge? Why?	
Who do you report to? How is your success measured?	
Is [decision-maker] aware of this challenge?	
How does [challenge] affect their ability to meet the business expectations and how are they being measured?	
How would solving [problems] bring you closer to [strategic objectives]?	
What happens if we don't address this [pain/challenge] now?	
When do you need this resolved?	
How much money are you willing to spend to fix this problem?	

Technical Questions:

Where do your employees clock in and out today?	
What is your POS?	
Who are you using for payroll?	
How often are you paying your employees?	



Stage 1: Qualify



Pain Funnel

When conducting discovery, avoid getting stuck on surface-level questions. Leverage the “Pain Funnel” below to dig deeper into your prospect’s pain points.

Tell me more about that...

Can you be a bit more specific?

How long has that been a problem?

What have you tried to do about that?

And did it work?

How much do you think that
has cost you?

How do you feel about that?

Have you given up trying
to deal with the problem?



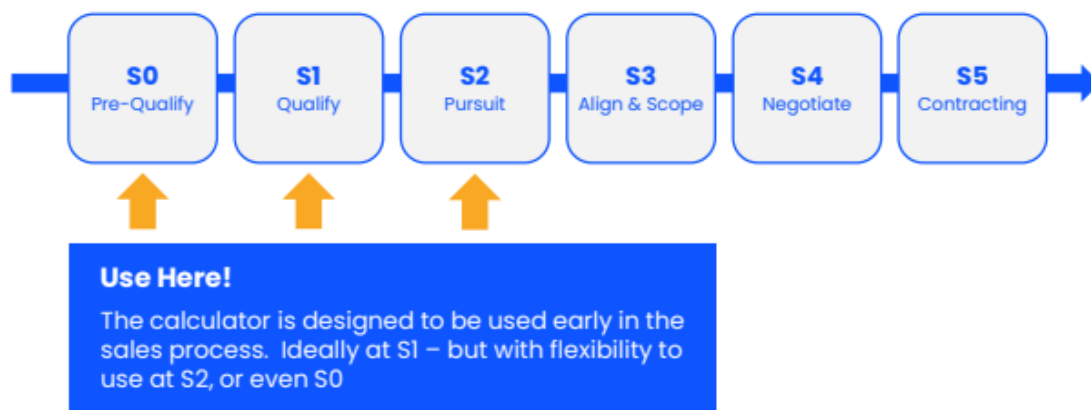
Value Calculator

What is it?

Value selling is a key part of our sales strategy. **The Value Calculator** is a tool to quickly quantify the potential value to early-stage prospects, keeping them engaged in the sales process and not just focused on features.

When do I use the Value Calculator?

When on a call with a prospect, share the value calculator on your screen. Populate any inputs and engage them in follow-up questions. This can occur in **Stages 0, 1, or 2**, but it must be done early in the sales cycle to keep prospects engaged in the process.



How to structure your call with the prospect:

Using the Value Calculator helps the prospect (and you!) to quantify the potential value their business can realize by partnering with Fourth. Secondly, it provides a vehicle for you to have a conversation about the prospect's business and what they are trying to achieve.

Call Structure Overview:

1. Introduction (2-3 minutes)
2. Capturing the prospect's input and understanding the context (5-7 minutes)
3. Presenting the Value Calculator outputs (10-15 minutes)
4. Overcoming objections & addressing questions (5-10 minutes)
5. Closing & next steps (3-5 minutes)

Value Calculator Explainer Guide





Stage 1: Qualify

Additional Discovery Best Practices:

- Remember the importance of **active listening**.
 - Paraphrase the buyer's answer back to them to let the buyer know that you are engaged. This also ensures that nothing is lost in translation and that what you hear is indeed what the buyer is trying to communicate.
- **Utilize BANT** to help you win early or lose early. By the end of your call, you should be able to provide a response to the following questions:

BUDGET – How much is the prospect able and willing to spend?

AUTHORITY – Who is the ultimate decision maker?

NEED – Does the prospect have a problem our solution can solve?

TIMING – Is there urgency?

Identifying the Champion:

How do you know if you've identified and formed a relationship with a true champion? You should be able to check all four of the boxes below:

- ✓ They are well-respected and have influence within their organization.
- ✓ They have a personal gain in deploying our solution.
- ✓ They have direct access to the person who has authority to buy (and can get access quickly).
- ✓ They are actively selling on our behalf.

Once you have identified your champion, you need to further validate them. They should be able to answer the following questions:

WHY are we doing this? (their problem)

WHY solve it with you? (Fourth)

WHAT results will we get for using your solution?

WHEN will we get the results we want?

WHY are we confident that we will get the results we want?



Stage 1: Qualify

Concluding your Discovery Call:

Your discovery call will likely end in any of the five ways highlighted below. The main objective is to identify the prospect's pain points and set clear next steps which may be a demo or directing them to further nurturing content.

Prospect:	Your Response:
"Not interested."	"I understand. Are there others that would benefit from our solution? Based on what we've talked about, I think that we could greatly benefit your business."
"Not interested but keep me around."	"I understand. This time might not be right for you, but I am happy to restart the conversation whenever you're ready. In the meantime, I'll send you some case studies of how some of our customers have solved similar problems."
"I'm the wrong person to talk to."	"I understand. Is there someone else I should talk to that can give me a better feel for your current process and potential challenges? Would you be able to make the introduction?"
"Sounds like you can help. What's next?"	• Schedule a solution demo • Provide any materials discussed in initial call and call summary of pain • Receive and follow up on any example reports from prospect
"Email me some more information."	This is an excuse to get off the phone or they need to do their own background research before proceeding. • Share a Digital Sales Room with them while still on the phone. • Schedule time to review. • Do not end call without scheduling follow-up.



Stage 2: Pursuit

Deeper Discovery



Stage 2: Pursuit

Goal: Engage in deeper discovery with the prospect using implication questions to build need and handle any objections/roadblocks.

How do I enter this stage?

Entry to Stage 2:

- You know: POS, payroll system, pay period, tip management, pay card present, tip card present
- Demo scheduled with HR, Payroll, Finance, IT
- Potential champion and metrics identified
- Reviewed business need discovery questions and identified how to position

What happens at this stage?

Activities:

- Account Executive and Solutions Engineer engage in deeper discovery using both technical questions and implication questions to build urgency
- Confirmed current state, future state (vision), budget, and Economic Buyer
- Build Champion/Identify Coach(s)
- Discuss project prioritization and reconfirm timelines
- Mutual Action Plan is created with the Champion to work through the deal

Exit to Stage 3:

- Demo completed
- Champion confirmed
- Mutual Action Plan shared with Champion (timeline confirmed)
- Metrics/ROI shared
- Influence map of all buyers documented
- PS lead engaged
- Initial PS scope documented
- Confirm budget
- Create quote
- Scheduled next meeting





Stage 2: Pursuit

Deeper Discovery

After uncovering as much about the prospect as you can in your first conversation, you will use the second call to dig deeper into the prospect's pain points alongside a Solutions Engineer. You will also share more information about our solutions and cater the discussion to the specific pain points and needs that you identified in your first conversation.

At this stage, you may customize the Restaurant Operations Suite deck to share information related to your prospect's specific interests.

Below are deeper-dive discovery questions that you should use to guide your conversations. Remember to dig deep on each question; rather than accepting the prospect's answer at face value, continue to ask, "why?" or "how?" to get to the root of their pain.

Implication Questions (Hiring):

Answers:

How much time do your managers dedicate to this process per week? If you could streamline this process, what would your managers be able to do with the [amount of time] they got back?	
How does candidate drop-off affect the number of qualified candidates that apply to open positions?	
Would reducing the average time to hire help streamline your hiring process?	
How many qualified candidates do you typically lose to other businesses that offer a shorter hiring period?	
What analytics and insights do you have to understand application data, hiring metrics, and manager responsiveness? Where are the gaps?	
Where do you invest money to sponsor jobs? Where could this money be better spent?	
Why would strengthening your hiring/onboarding process be impactful to your business?	





Stage 2: Pursuit

Implication Questions (Schedule):

Answers:

What are the consequences of having understaffed shifts during peak hours on customer service and wait times?	
How does the lack of proper scheduling affect your ability to manage inventory and control food costs?	
How does inconsistent scheduling affect your staff's morale and retention rates?	
What are the implications of frequent scheduling changes on your ability to provide a consistent customer experience?	
What are the financial implications of having to frequently adjust staffing levels due to scheduling issues?	
How does poor scheduling impact staff morale and retention, and what does that mean for your overall team stability?	
What are the consequences of not having a well-organized scheduling system on your ability to train and integrate new employees effectively?	

Implication Questions (Manage/Pay):

Answers:

How do manual HR and payroll processes impact your team's efficiency and productivity?	
How many errors are made during a typical payroll cycle?	
How do these error affect your business?	
Have you turned your HR department into a profit center by mitigating risk and reducing turnover? If not, what's stopping you?	
Where are your profit margins today, and where do you want them to be? How might reallocating your time to revenue-generating activity help increase your margins?	
How much are you losing in revenue when managers do not properly staff employees?	
How do workforce management issues affect employee morale and satisfaction within your organization?	



Stage 2: Pursuit

Implication Questions (Manage/Pay):

Answers:

How do workforce management issues affect employee morale and satisfaction within your organization?	
What risks or liabilities do you face due to non-compliance with labor laws and regulations?	
How do you hold managers accountable for things like opening and closing checklists? How often are tasks forgotten or overlooked?	
How would your task management improve if it could all be done from one application?	
How do you currently store documents such as recipes and kitchen guides? Would you find it valuable to have one central, online location to store these resources?	
If you could streamline your reporting process, what would your managers be able to do with the time they got back? What would you do with the money you saved in labor costs?	

Implication Questions (Pay/Retain):

Answers:

How might your business improve if you were able to attract and hire more qualified candidates?	
Our industry standard for turnover typically ranges between 70%-95%. What is your turnover range? How much revenue is lost to hiring new employees?	
What are you doing to differentiate yourself from the competition regarding the benefits you offer?	
How do you address employee concerns about payday loans?	
What is the productivity cost of relying on cash deliveries or frequent bank visits to keep cash on hand?	
Have you lost out on employees that want an electronic tip payout solution?	
Would your employees be more satisfied if they were able to receive their tips electronically?	

Stage 2: Pursuit



Below are a few strategies that can strengthen your Stage 2 discovery conversations.

Question Behind the Question

Answer their question and then ask what is prompting that question.

Why it works?

- The reason for the questions is more interesting than the question
- Gets the prospect to admit their "real problem"

What does it look like?

- "To best answer that, what are you specifically wanting to accomplish?"
- "Our solution does not do that. How important is that to you making this decision?"

Psychological Mirroring

Imitate the prospect's behavior.

Why it works?

- People like those that empathize with them
- Helps build credibility and trust
- Helps to clear up any uncertainties through repetition

What does it look like?

Customer: "We had a bad experience."

Rep: "I'm sorry, a bad experience?"

SAY NOTHING ELSE!

Paint Pictures of Pain with Labeling

The act of verbalizing feelings with the intent to make them easier to overcome.

Why it works?

- Shows that you're interested
- Helps you gain trust and loyalty
- **Observe** without reaction or judgement.
- **Marinate:** Acknowledge the pain and probe for more
- **Confirm:** Their negative consequences are real.
- **Replace:** Negative with a positive outcome/ proof.
- **Ask:** How would it feel if/then?
- **Pause:** Wait for an answer

Determining the Price

Deliver the number directly and then wait. Keep it short and sweet. After a pause, ask, "how does that feel?"

If faced with "it's too expensive," try these responses:

- What else have you seen in the marketplace?
- Can you help me understand why you feel it's expensive?
- What did you have budgeted?
- How was the budget determined?
- I understand, the market dictates the price.



Stage 2: Mutual Action Plan

A Mutual Action Plan:

- **Is collaborative:** Outlines the process for completing a deal
- **Creates alignment:** Aligns both the buyer and the seller on key milestones, responsibilities, and timelines
- **Reduces risk:** Focuses on mutual success and reduces the risks of deal delays or failures
- **Is a shared framework:** Helps track progress and decision-making
- **Is not just as seller's tool:** Co-created with the buyer to ensure commitment

Benefits of Mutual Action Plans:

Buyer-Seller Agreement:

- Both parties have clear expectations of what needs to happen.
- Reduces misunderstandings, sets a roadmap to achieve a mutual goal.

Increased Accountability:

- Identifies who is responsible for each action on both sides.
- Clear ownership of tasks and timelines.

Accelerates the Sales Process:

- Ensures quicker decision-making by laying out timelines for decisions.
- Helps prevent deals from stalling due to miscommunication or delays.

Trust Building:

- Co-creation builds credibility and demonstrates partnership, not just selling.

Mutual Action Plan Template





Stage 2: Pursuit

How to Handle No Response from Prospects

Stage 2: Pursuit



Email Templates for No Response

#1: Going over or around

Subject: I will try someone else.

Hi John,

Hey, I know we've had a few conversations over the last 4 weeks about _____ and we have yet to receive your information.

I appreciate you are super busy. I think at this point I will work on speaking with others in the organization to see if we can get some traction.

My goal is not to offend you. In fact, it's just the opposite. I want to capitalize on your enthusiasm and move us forward.

#2: Multiple Choice

Hey Ben,

As I mentioned in our first discussion, we always want to make sure we're on the same page. Usually when I go this long without hearing from someone it means one of the following:

1. There are questions or frustrations with the program.
2. All is well and other priorities are taking precedence.
3. Something else.

Would you mind responding with a 1, 2, or 3 so I can provide the best support to you?

#3: Status Update Request

Subject: Status Update Request

Hi John,

I know things are changing rapidly for people these days.

Last we spoke we discussed having _____ and _____ information provide by **<DATE>**.

Since we are past that timeline can you please provide a status update so I don't bug you over and over again?

#4: Have you given up?

Subject: Have you given up?

Hi John,

Have you given up on completing this project by the end of the _____? (month, quarter, year)



Stage 2: Pursuit

Follow-Ups



Stage 2: Pursuit

Follow-Ups:

As a follow-up to your meeting, you should send an email summarizing the prospect's main business goals, priorities, timeline, and budget that you uncovered.

Use the template below to write your email.

Email Template:

Hi [**Prospect**],

As we discussed, your business goal for 2024-25 is to [**state the business goal discussed**].

Top 2 Priorities:

- **Insert 1st priority**
- Challenge: [**Insert Challenge**]
- **Insert 2nd priority**
- Challenge: [**Insert Challenge**]

Your [**decision maker**] is looking to resolve the above challenges [**restate the challenges**] and increase revenue by [%] by the end of [**time period**].

- If we can stay within your budget of [\$] we could see [**X,Y,Z**] in ROI.
- I am looking forward to our next call on [**date**] where we will review our core capabilities that will help resolve the challenges in the top [**# of priorities**] priorities.



Stage 2: Pursuit

Example Email Follow-Up:

Below is an example email using the template on the previous page.

Hi **Sarah**,

Your business goal for 2024-25 is to **(add 20 new locations)**.

Top 2 Priorities:

- **Improve employee scheduling**
 - Challenge: **40% shifts are understaffed due to complexity of labor scheduling**
- **Accelerate employee efficiencies**
 - Challenge: **8 hours/week is too long for scheduling**

Your **COO** is looking to resolve the above challenges **to keep the shifts 100% staffed and to bring the number of hours down to 2/week, which frees up 6 hours/location to serve more customers** and increase revenue by **at least 20%** by the end of **May**.

- If we can stay within your budget of **\$30K** we could see a **10%** in ROI.
- I am looking forward to our next call on **Tuesday, May 3rd at 2:00pm** where we will review our core capabilities that will help resolve the challenges in the **top 2 priorities**.



Stage 3: Align & Scope



Stage 3: Align & Scope

Goal: Engage Solutions Executives and Consultants to gather technical information and provide a demo.

How do I enter this stage?

Entry to Stage 3:

- Demo completed
- Champion confirmed
- Mutual Action Plan shared with Champion (timeline confirmed)
- Metrics/ROI shared
- Influence map of all buyers documented
- PS lead engaged
- Initial PS scope documented
- Confirm budget
- Create quote
- Schedule next meeting

What happens at this stage?

Activities:

- Solutions provides demo(s) based on the prospect's interest
- Define success criteria (pain, gain, vision)
- Fourth differentiators are clearly understood and part of decision criteria
- Determine scope of deployment (integrations, workflows, etc.)
- Pricing is discussed and shared with prospect
- POS/Product vetting if necessary
- Mutual Action Plan is confirmed with Champion

Exit to Stage 4:

- Champion tested (successfully)
- Metrics jointly confirmed with champion
- Mutual Action Plan confirmed with champion
- Procurement/legal identified
- Fourth leadership alignment established
- Scoping workshop completed
- Draft SOW completed
- Reconfirm budget
- Proposal has been presented





Stage 3: Align & Scope

Engaging Solutions Executives & Consultants

Sales Team Responsibilities:

- Creating Pre-Sales Resource Request case in Salesforce to request assistance on any customer demonstration call
- Scheduling and facilitating an internal collaboration meeting prior to the demonstration to align on opportunity and communicate all qualification and discovery that has been completed
- Scheduling and facilitating the demo with the customer
- Handling the objections, questions, and feedback from the customer
- Prepare a customized pitch deck that incorporates any relevant information about the prospect and the solutions they might be interested in
- Create and present the proposal to the customer
- Negotiate the terms, conditions, and pricing of the deal

Solution Center Responsibilities:

- Preparing and delivering the demo with the customer
- Showcasing the features, benefits, and value of the solution for the customer
- Provide technical and domain input and validation to the proposal, and ensure the accuracy, completeness, and feasibility of the solution
- Provide Statements of Work (SOWs) for opportunities where standard SOWs are not available



Stage 3: Align & Scope

Shared Responsibilities:

- Collaborate to design and customize the demo script, scenario, and data for each opportunity
- Communicate regularly and share relevant information and insights about the customer's interests, concerns, and expectations
- Agree on the next steps and actions for each opportunity, and assign clear owners and deadlines for each task
- Collaborate to develop and refine the proposal content, format, and structure for each opportunity
- Communicate regularly and share relevant information and insights about the customer's feedback, questions, and concerns
- Agree on the next steps and actions for each opportunity, and assign clear owners and deadlines for each task

Using Consensus:

- For single product opportunities less than 10 locations, the AE will complete the demonstration or Consensus will be used for Demonstrations.
- For opportunities greater than 10 locations, the Sales team will create a Consensus DemoBoard and send it to the customer prior to a live demonstration.



Stage 3: Align & Scope

Objection Handling



Objection Handling

As the prospect starts to learn more about our solutions and consider us against the competition, they will likely raise objections and questions. Explore a few general objection-handling best practices below:

Objection Handling Best Practices:

- Always clarify the objection. You need to ensure you are reacting to what they are saying – no assumptions.
- Demonstrate that you understand their concern and *why* it is a concern.
- Respond to the objection with as many facts as possible.
- Once you have resolved the objection they have, ask if there are any other objections that you can help them with; never assume you have resolved the issue until the prospect says you have.

Explore common objections that sales reps face here at Fourth on the next few pages of the playbook, as well as how to best respond to them.

Objection: “This is expensive. We don’t really have the budget.”

Ask:

- “Compared to what?” – Identify the competitor we are being measured against
- “If you don’t mind me asking, why would our price/budget be an issue for you and your team at this time?”
- “Is price/budget the only issue that you’re struggling with right now, or are there any other issues you’re dealing with?”
- “If budget is an issue, what is the price range that you would feel comfortable moving forward with?”

Say:

“I hear you. Nobody wants to spend money without getting something back, and we agree 100%. The truth is, you’re getting a lot from Fourth that other companies just don’t offer. Not only do you get [insert features/benefits related to pain point], but you also get [feature that differentiates us from the competition].”



Objection Handling

Objection: “The timing is not good. We have other more pressing priorities.”

Ask:

- “Is there a reason this timing is not right?”
- “What other high priority projects are you working on right now?”
- “Would reducing time spent on [hiring/scheduling/managing] alleviate any of the other problems that you’re dealing with?”
- “How long has [business need] been on your priority list?”
- If you could eliminate [manual scheduling/time-consuming hiring processes/etc.], how would that impact the business?

Say:

“I understand that there are actions that you need to take that will occupy your team and budget in the near term. However, we’ve seen our products make a significant impact on the productivity and profitability of teams like yours. When would be a good time to discuss [how we can solve for X problem]?”

Objection: “Our current system is good enough. I don’t want to spend the time and money to change something that is already fine.” (Fear of change management)

Ask:

- “What would [reduced time scheduling/streamlined hiring/etc.] mean to your department in terms of [cost, time savings, additional revenue]?”
- “How much does it cost you hire and onboard employees?”
- “How much time do you spend creating schedules?”
- “What would an improvement in [scheduling/hiring/managing/payroll] efficiencies do for the company?”
- “How much time does your team spend on [scheduling/hiring/managing/etc.] as opposed to working on more complex projects?”

Say:

“I hear you. You’ve been using the same system for a long time, and you know how it works. With Fourth, we not only provide the ability to manage your employee lifecycle from hire to retire, but we also can streamline your scheduling process and optimize your labor through AI-powered reporting. Can I schedule a 30-minute conversation to discuss how we can partner with you to [save you X amount of money]?”





Stage 4: Negotiate



Stage 4: Negotiate

Goal: Negotiate with the client to secure a sale and share a clear path for next steps and timeline.

How do I enter this stage?

Entry to Stage 4:

- Champion tested (successfully)
- Metrics jointly confirmed with champion
- Procurement/Legal identified
- Fourth leadership alignment established
- Scoping workshop completed
- Draft SOW completed
- Reconfirm budget
- Proposal has been presented

What happens at this stage?

Activities:

- Reconfirm scope of deployment
- Mutual Action Plan and business case are shared with Economic Buyer
- Reference calls scheduled (if required)
- Reconfirm signing process (meetings, board evaluation, approvers, timeframe, systems)
- Introduce Fourth executive sponsor (if not already introduced)
- Purchasing and Legal engaged
- Final pricing agreed
- Final SOW completed

Exit to Stage 5:

- Verbal commitment that you are the vendor/solution of choice
- ROI and Mutual Action Plan reviewed and accepted by Economic Buyer
- Contract(s) sent
- Legal and/or procurement contracts established
- Professional Stage kick-off confirmed
- One turn of redlines (if applicable)
- Reference calls completed





Stage 4: Negotiate

Engaging Solutions Executives & Consultants

Sales Team Responsibilities:

- Create and present the proposal to the customer
- Negotiate the terms, conditions, and pricing of the deal

Solution Center Responsibilities:

- Provide technical and domain input and validation to the proposal, and ensure the accuracy, completeness, and feasibility of the solution
- Provide Statements of Work (SOWs) for opportunities where standard SOWs are not available

Shared Responsibilities:

- Collaborate to develop and refine the proposal content, format, and structure for each opportunity
- Communicate regularly and share relevant information and insights about the customer's feedback, questions, and concerns
- Agree on the next steps and actions for each opportunity, and assign clear owners and deadlines for each task



Stage 4: Negotiate

Negotiation Tactics Buyers Use and How to Handle Them:

“This sounds great, but my boss won’t go for it.”

In this case, the buyer blames another person (usually their boss) for blocking progress. Because it often happens in the later stages of a negotiation, this tactic limits the seller’s ability to handle objections. The buyer is hoping to win even more concessions.

How to respond: Ask to speak directly with the decision-maker, saying you want to hear their concerns so you can address them. Don’t fall for the trick of being forced to rely on the middleman.

“Let’s just meet in the middle.”

A buyer who provides a much higher or lower starting number than is realistic can make the seller feel like they’ve negotiated a good deal when they meet in the middle. For example, a buyer might tell you their budget is \$25,000 when it’s closer to \$50,000, hoping to force the price down.

How to respond: It’s hard to know where the real middle lies. So, don’t focus on an imaginary middle. Instead, come up with something you know to be fair. If their budget really can’t cover your offer, rework the deal and see how you can shift things around to accommodate the lower number.

“I met with your competitor, and they gave me a better offer.”

Bringing up a competitor is a good way for the buyer to get the terms they want. They know the pressure will be on the seller to give them a better offer.

How to respond: First, you don’t need to counter with an offer that tops your competitor’s. Recognize the value in what you’re offering. If you can’t beat them in terms of price, what other strengths do you possess that your competitor doesn’t? Maybe you can offer better customer service or more features.



Stage 4: Negotiate

“You have until tomorrow to come up with a better deal.”

This tactic can drive salespeople to drop their price or even skip important details, which could harm the relationship in the long run.

How to respond: Don't bend to the pressure. Tell the buyer they'll be getting the short end of the stick if they want something in a hurry. Then counter with a reasonable timeframe that allows you to come up with the best possible solution for the buyer.

“If you could give me this one thing, we can move.”

Good negotiators pull out this card at the last possible second. They make an offhand remark about a new, final item because they assume you'll budge because you're eager to close.

How to respond: Negotiate any last-minute request just as you did with other details. Don't make a concession just to make the deal happen. When they see the tactic fall flat, they'll probably back down.

“I need more (and more and more) time to think about it.”

Stalling puts the salesperson in a bind because they can neither move forward nor pull back.

How to respond: Ask if they'd be willing to chat. Getting to the bottom of the problem can help you find a way to move forward. For example, you might say, “I understand you might need more time. Can we take five minutes and talk about it together?”

“You're asking too much.”

How to respond: Take control of the situation by remaining calm. Ask specific questions about why the offer doesn't work and demonstrate a willingness to listen and negotiate. Let them express their feelings so they can cool down, but if their outrage gets into bullying or intimidation, remove yourself from the situation.



Stage 5: Send Contract



Stage 5: Send Contract

Goal: Send contract and close the deal. Ensure that all are in alignment.

How do I enter this stage?

Entry to Stage 5:

- ROI and Mutual Action Plan are reviewed and accepted by Economic Buyer
- Contract(s) sent
- Legal and/or procurement contracts established
- Professional Stage kick-off confirmed
- One turn of redlines (if applicable)
- Reference calls completed

What happens at this stage?

Activities:

- Continue negotiating if necessary and finalize all terms and conditions
- Multiple turns of redlines (if needed)
- Secure signed contracts
- Reconfirm implementation and go-live plan
- Terms & Conditions agreed

Exit to Close:

- Terms & Conditions agreed
- All contracts executed
- Have actioned any corrections needed by Sales Operations if necessary
- Opportunity is Closed Won in Salesforce





Stage 5: Send Contract

Engaging Solutions Executives & Consultants

Sales Team Responsibilities:

- Close the deal with the customer
- Obtain final approval, signature, and payment from the customer

Solution Center Responsibilities:

- Support the Sales Team in the closing process
- Provide any technical information or clarification to the customer

Shared Responsibilities:

- Collaborate to finalize and deliver the contract, Statement of Work, and other documents to the customer
- Communicate regularly and share relevant information and insights about the customer's status, issues, and expectations
- Agree on next steps and actions for each opportunity, and assign clear owners and deadlines for each task



Stage 5: Send Contract

How to Transition into Closing:

How to Tell If a Buyer is Ready to Close:

The buyer usually won't say "yes" if they have doubts about any of the following questions:

- What are the features and benefits of this product or service?
- How do they apply to my business?
- How can I implement this solution, and what is it going to cost me?
- What are the short-term and long-term cost benefits of this purchase?
- Why is this solution better for me than others on the market?
- Is this a reasonable price?

If the seller hasn't provided the buyer with the answers to these questions, then they are likely not ready. If the seller tries to close now, they might risk losing the sale.

Five Questions to Get You to Closing:

1. Is your solution the best fit for the buyer's needs?

If the answer to the above is no, you're not ready to close. Framing the question this way allows you to figure out what work you need to do to help the buyer better understand how you can help. If the answer is yes, and you're confident you've both explored the specific ways the buyer would benefit from your solution, you are probably ready to close.

Question for closing: "Based on our conversations, I'm confident we can help you solve X with our solution. Would you agree?"

2. What's the timeline for closing?

Steer the conversation naturally by asking for a timeline. Let's say your buyer has told you they want to implement a solution by August. Calculate how long it will take for you to send a contract, what the process for approval looks like on either end, and the timing for implementation.

Question for closing: "We'll need about two weeks to prepare if you'd like to implement by August. If I send you a contract today, would you be able to send it back by July 15?"



Stage 5: Send Contract

3. What's preventing the buyer from moving forward?

A direct approach may work best if the buyer stalls. Allow the buyer to voice any final objections or explain why they can't move forward. Or, they might say nothing is stopping them from closing, enabling you to close.

Question for closing: "Is there anything preventing us from moving forward at this time?"

4. Which proposed solution does the buyer prefer?

If you've proposed multiple options for the buyer, you can ask them to select the one that best fits their needs. Once they express a preference, they are more likely to commit to the sale.

Question for closing: "I've outlined A, B, and C as potential ways to solve your problem. Which one of these will work the best for you?"

5. Is solving this problem a priority?

Separating serious prospects from window-shoppers will prevent you from wasting time—while also building relationships for the future.

Question for closing: "Is this solution a priority for you today? If not, when are you looking to implement something like this?"

Closing is often advertised as the most important step in the sales process. However, closing a deal won't happen if you don't follow the right steps along the way. Before you ask the buyer to make their final decision, check that they're ready and address any lingering doubts they may have.



Stage 6: Close & Post-Sale



Stage 6: Close

Congratulations! You successfully closed a deal. Now what?

Implementation

Access all resources related to **implementation** by clicking on the icon.



Customer Success Relationship

Access the **Customer Success Portal** by clicking on the icon.



What is Customer Success?

Customer Success **helps customers achieve their goals using a company's products or services**. It improves building strong relationships with customers and being proactive in addressing their needs before they reach out. The goal is to make the customers love the product or service so much that they want to continue using it and purchasing in the future.

- There are three stages of Customer Success:
 - **Adoption**: get customer to realize the value in what they purchased
 - **Retention**: make sure the customer is satisfied with the solution
 - **Expansion**: expanding the Fourth footprint.
- Customer Success is not always about selling; rather, it focuses on expanding the use of our solutions. Ensuring that customers are using all features available to them makes us stickier.

What is the Relationship Between Customer Success and Sales?

- Customer Success and Sales have a “hunter and farmer” relationship.
 - Following a sale, the sales rep continues to foster relationship.
 - They check in on how everything is going so far, look for upsell/cross-sell opportunities, and continue to be engaged for at least a year.
 - Around 6-8 months post-sale, the rep starts adding the CSM to meetings.



Stage 6: Close

Expansion

Expansion is focused on growing revenue post-sale through a combination of nurturing existing customer relationships and helping them to see Fourth's value and continuing to build loyalty over time.

Is the Account Ready for Expansion?

Looking at all accounts as expansion targets is a recipe for disaster. Look at the process of expansion as a three-step process:

Look for quantitative and qualitative data points which would highlight expansion opportunity.

- Before you can expand with this account, the customer must trust you and see value in your product. If not at that point, play the long game and nurture them until they do.
- Once your account is ready for expansion, run the plays and go after the opportunity!

Prioritize:

Track Customer Adoption: From initial sign on to Fourth, information from sales as well as ongoing engagement with the platform will help to put a spotlight on customers that have a higher opportunity for expansion versus others

Earn the Right to Expand:

Strengthen Relationship: An existing customer will always be evaluating and thinking about existing relationships. Think about the customer's emotional narrative. What has Fourth done for me? Why should I grow with Fourth? Being able to find positive signals and red flags within existing relationships can help better determine if the customer is ready to expand.

Monetize:

Leverage Relationship: If an account is primed for expansion, it is important more than ever to coordinate with marketing and product on the opportunity and leverage your account plan to be properly prepared.



Stage 6: Close

Cross-Selling

Cross-selling is a way for reps to sell additional related or complimentary products, solutions, or services to a customer. When done effectively, cross-selling to our customers should be a seamless, logical addition to the purchase that they've already made.

Why Cross-Sell?

- **Stickier customer relationship:** The more of our solutions the customer adds, the stickier Fourth becomes. It's difficult to separate yourself from a service provider when your business relies on multiple offerings to run their business.
- **Additional value for the customer:** With each additional product, the customer is exposed to the increasing benefits of Fourth's solutions.
- **Leads to business referrals:** It doesn't take long for other peers to observe that what works for our customers could work for them. If we can sell not just one, but multiple offerings to customers, then it means they like what we do, and will be more willing to make an introduction or act as a reference to prospects.

Techniques for Cross-Selling:

- **Identify Opportunities to Introduce New Products:** You need to be able to identify the need for a new product or package by recognizing the individual pain points of the customer. Don't wait for them to come and ask you for a new offering.
- **Identify Customers Who Are Ready for Cross-Sell:** Before you approach a customer, be sure that they can accept what you're offering. Don't just make the same pitch to everyone in your portfolio and hope for the best.
- **Stay Consistent:** Just because a customer turns down the opportunity for a cross-sell one year, doesn't mean that it won't be open to the same cross-sell in the future. If you really identify a need, then it's only a matter of time before you can mention the idea of a cross-sell again.
- **Move the Conversation Up:** If your champions aren't interested in a new product, ask them to help you talk to people who would be.



Stage 6: Close

Identifying and Pursuing Expansion Opportunities:

Expansion opportunities are central to the revenue strategy of the company. Below are best practices that will help you prepare and introduce new up-sell and cross-sell offerings to customers who would benefit from their use.



Ask Probing Questions

Ask questions to get the customer to discuss the challenges they are facing. This will make the introduction of new offerings flow more naturally when you bring it up.



Plan the Timing

Be sensitive to the sales cycle of the customer. That allows the organization to consider the benefits of the opportunity without being distracted by more pressing issues.



Personalize your Recommendations

Once you have identified pain points and understand the value that an offering can provide to a customer, you should personalize your recommendations. This helps the customer answer, “what’s in it for me?”



Follow-Up

It often takes multiple interactions to convince customers of the value of the offering. After you make the initial pitch, be sure to follow up and answer any questions that they may have about what you presented to them.



Stage 6: Close

Expansion Opportunities

To identify expansion opportunities with customers, you should use your current experience and relationship with the account to deeply understand their needs and determine recommendations and align solutions.

Identify expansion opportunities by asking the questions below:

- What do they value about the product and what are their current needs?
- Did I sell a small portion of the potential cross-sell?
- What do I need to do to introduce more solutions to the customer?
- Do I have the right relationships?
- Do they have existing systems that could be displaced?
- What did the account plan tell us?
- What additional pains can we solve for?
- Where are the other parts of the business that can also benefit?
- How do I gain access to the right people?
- What are the quantifiable impacts of the solutions? (time, money, compliance, more strategic tasks, etc.)
- What is my approach strategy?

Expansion Question Bank:

- What is the most important outcome for your business right now?
- What goals would you like to accomplish over the next 3 months? 6 months? Year?
- What process did you go through to determine your needs?
- What are your most important purchases and why are they important?
- What are your top priorities when it comes to improving efficiency?
- What are the 3 biggest challenges you are facing at this moment?
- What are your main questions or concerns about Fourth's ability to help you reach your goals?
- Tell me about your experience.
- What would be an ideal outcome for the teams that use our software?

Sales Competencies

Sales competencies are the skills that help a seller influence someone's buying decisions.

Below are the competencies we focus on here at Fourth:

1. Understanding and knowledge of the financial aspects, operational processes, and regulatory compliance requirements within the hospitality industry.
2. Building and nurturing strong and mutually beneficial relationships with customers and stakeholders to achieve sales goals and long-term success.
3. Identifying potential customers, initiating contact, and conducting effective discovery conversations to uncover customer needs and opportunities.
4. Evaluating and determining the suitability of potential opportunities by assessing factors such as budget, authority, need, and timeline (BANT) to prioritize sales efforts.
5. Delivering engaging presentations and product demonstrations to showcase the value and benefits of Fourth solutions to potential customers.
6. Engaging in discussions and negotiations with customers to reach mutually agreeable terms and successfully close deals.
7. Effectively use established sales processes and tools to streamline lead identification, opportunity management, and pipeline management.
8. Effectively managing time and resources to optimize productivity, prioritize tasks, and achieve sales targets.
9. Adhering to structured sales methodologies and processes that guide the sales journey from lead generation to deal closure.
10. Collaborating effectively cross-functionally within the organization to ensure a coordinated and successful approach to opportunity closure.
- 11-14. Depth of understanding and familiarity of Fourth's solutions, enabling confident and accurate articulation of the value, advantages, and capabilities of these offerings to potential customers.

